

Jens Laufer

Forward Deployed Engineer — LLM agents running in production, inside the systems a business already has

Python · LLM agents, tool use & MCP · agent harness (loop, memory, approval gates, observability, budget control) · RAG · REST APIs & enterprise integration (SAP, ESB, canonical data models) · Java / Spring Boot · Docker / CI

I build the harness: the loop, the tools, the memory, the gates and the observability that turn a language model into a system somebody can rely on while nobody is watching. Two of mine run in production today — an autonomous AI business partner that plans, writes code, tests and deploys around the clock, and Fabrik, a multi-agent platform where worker agents ship software in parallel. Before that, sixteen years of back-end and integration work sitting with the customer: invoice platforms, handing invoices to SAP over an ESB, master data migration at a major bank, an industry file format in utility billing. That is the forward deployed combination — the AI side, and the side where ERP, CRM and document workflows have been running for decades. Freelance since 1997, so requirements, delivery and production support have always been the same conversation.

AVAILABLE immediately	WORKS remote only	REMOTE SHARE 100 % 0 % on-site
HOURLY RATE €100/h on-site €95/h remote · excl. VAT	BASED IN Karlstein am Main Germany	

FOCUS

Harness engineering is the work, in production since 10/2025: agent loop with stop conditions, **tool use over MCP**, layered memory, RAG, approval gates before anything irreversible, quality gates an agent must pass before it may ship, observability over every run, budget and rate-limit control with model routing and fallback, and recovery after a killed run.

Two harnesses running live: an autonomous AI business partner that plans, writes code, tests and deploys around the clock, and **Fabrik**, a multi-agent platform where worker agents pick up tickets and ship in parallel. A local multi-model proxy keeps both independent of any single provider.

Forward deployed by habit: freelance since 1997, always inside the customer's team (Telekom, Commerzbank, Volkswagen, Audi, DVAG, Brunata) — scoping in conversation, delivering on site or remote, staying through production.

Integration into systems that already exist: invoice handover to **SAP** over an ESB (1&1), master data migration on a canonical XML model (Commerzbank), the Haweiko-Arge industry format in heating cost billing (Brunata).

Prototype to production: took over a running prototype at Deutsche Telekom, developed it further and put it live — with the Docker/Kubernetes, tracing and CI work that being live actually requires.

Python and back-end depth: REST back-ends in Python (Eve, Flask) and Java/Spring Boot microservices with OpenAPI, shipped in Docker, test-driven throughout.

ROLES

- Full-stack engineering
- Solution design
- Backend engineering
- DevOps
- Build & configuration management
- Data analysis
- Prototyping
- Machine learning
- Jenkins plugin development
- Maven plugin development

SKILLS

API / INTEGRATION

- REST
- Swagger
- OpenAPI
- SOAP
- Webservices
- CXF
- XFire
- Kafka
- ServiceMix

DEVOPS / CLOUD

- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Rancher
- GitLab CI
- Jenkins
- Maven
- Grunt
- npm
- Artifactory
- AWS (EC2, S3, SageMaker, VPC)
- Microsoft Azure
- DigitalOcean

FRONTEND

- Vue.js
- React
- AngularJS
- GWT
- Quasar
- HTML
- CSS
- Bootstrap

SECURITY / IAM

- Keycloak
- Spring Security
- OAuth2

MACHINE LEARNING

- scikit-learn
- Keras
- DeepLearning4J
- CNN
- Transfer Learning
- Supervised/Unsupervised
- k-means
- PCA
- t-SNE
- Reinforcement Learning
- OpenAI Gym
- Topic Modeling

TOOLING / OTHER

- Git
- GitLab
- Subversion
- Jira
- Confluence
- Kibana
- ANTLR
- JavaCC
- ZXing (QR)
- PayPal API
- RDF/XML/JSON
- SAP (BAPI)
- Phonegap
- JBoss
- Tomcat

LANGUAGES

- Java
- JavaScript
- TypeScript
- Python
- R
- Groovy

MICROSERVICES / BACKEND

- Spring Boot
- Spring
- Spring Data
- Spring Integration
- Spring Security
- OAuth2
- Microservices
- Feign
- Sleuth
- Zipkin
- Python Eve
- Python Flask
- Java EE
- EJB

PERSISTENCE / DATABASES

- MySQL
- MongoDB
- PostgreSQL
- Oracle
- Neo4j
- JPA
- Hibernate

TESTING

- JUnit
- TDD
- Mockito
- Selenium
- DBUnit
- Playwright

DATA SCIENCE

- pandas
- numpy
- dplyr
- Jupyter
- RMarkdown
- ggplot
- seaborn
- Vega-Lite
- A/B Testing
- Webscraping

PROJECT HISTORY (SELECTION FROM 2009)

since 10/2025
ongoing

Autonomous AI business partner — Harness & agentic engineering

Solytics GmbH · Remote — AI / Automation

Harness engineering · Agent engineering · AI system architecture · DevOps

A self-directing agent built on Claude that plans, writes code, tests, deploys and reports around the clock. Built as a **harness engineer** — the engineering around the model: the **agent loop** and its stop conditions, **tool use over MCP**, layered **memory** (durable facts, running context, session state), **approval gates** for anything irreversible, **observability** over every run, **budget and rate-limit control** with model routing, plus recovery when a run is killed mid-flight. More than 40 purpose-built checks catch the agent's mistakes before they reach a human. Event-driven over Telegram, GitHub and systemd; runs on own hardware behind a local multi-model proxy.

- Claude / Anthropic API
- LLM-Agenten
- Agent Harness
- Tool Use / MCP
- RAG
- Prompt Engineering
- Python
- systemd
- Telegram Bot API
- Docker
- TDD

07/2024–06/2025
12 months

Digital property profile for owners

verkaufe.immobilien · Remote — Internet

Full-stack engineering · Solution design · DevOps

Full-stack development of a digital property profile that owners create and maintain themselves: Vue.js front-end, Python back-end (Eve) with a REST API and MongoDB. Built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines for automated build and deployment. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build and operation of the services in Docker. Test-driven development, automated end-to-end tests with Playwright.

- Python
- Python Eve
- MongoDB
- TDD
- Vue.js
- Docker
- GitLab
- GitLab CI
- REST
- Playwright

07/2022–04/2024
22 months

Front- and back-end, heating cost billing

Brunata · Remote — Industry

Full-stack engineering · Solution design · DevOps

Production server-side services and APIs in Java and Spring Boot: a microservice that parses and generates heating-cost files in the Haweiko-Arge industry format. Designed and built in a microservices architecture with REST interfaces (OpenAPI, Swagger), secured with Spring Security and Keycloak, persisted in MongoDB. Built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines for automated build and deployment. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build and operation of the services in Docker. Test-driven development (JUnit, Mockito), automated end-to-end tests with Playwright. Front-end development.

- Java
- Spring Boot
- MongoDB
- JUnit
- TDD
- React
- Docker
- GitLab
- GitLab CI
- Spring Security
- Keycloak
- Mockito
- OpenAPI
- Swagger
- REST
- Microservices
- Playwright

01/2021–03/2021
3 months

Marketing campaign tooling

DigitalMarketer.com · Remote — Marketing

Full-stack engineering · Solution design

Tools that generate marketing campaigns and publish them to Google Ads and Twitter Ads: Java/Spring Boot microservices with REST interfaces (OpenAPI, Feign), Vue.js/Quasar front-end, storage in AWS S3. Designed and built in a microservices architecture. Built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build and operation of the services in Docker and Kubernetes.

- Scrum
- Spring Boot
- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Microservices
- REST
- Java
- OpenAPI
- Feign
- JUnit
- TDD
- Mockito
- Vue.js
- Quasar
- AWS S3
- GitLab CI
- GitLab

12/2019–12/2020

13 months

Web-based configuration of telecommunications devices

Deutsche Telekom · Darmstadt/Remote — Telecommunications

DevOps · Build & configuration management · Full-stack engineering

Took over an existing prototype for configuring telecommunications devices over a web interface, developed it further and moved it into production. Production server-side services and APIs in Java and Spring Boot in a microservices architecture (REST, Feign, Spring Data/JPA), Vue.js front-end, secured with Keycloak, persisted in MySQL and MongoDB. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build, operation and monitoring of the services: Docker and Kubernetes (Rancher), logging and tracing via Kibana, Sleuth and Zipkin; built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines.



07/2015–07/2017

25 months

Invoice management platform (SME)

Deutsche Verrechnungstelle / DVAG · Frankfurt a. Main — Insurance, Finance, Startup

Full-stack engineering

Platform covering the full invoice life cycle (creation, payment, dunning, debt collection); a range of Spring Boot microservices.



07/2019–12/2019

6 months

Training a stock-trading agent

JiGaoTrading · Remote — Finance

Machine learning · Data analysis

An agent that trades autonomously on Chinese stock exchanges (reinforcement learning).



04/2010–09/2010

6 months

Web services on an ESB (mediation and rating)

1&1 · Montabaur — Telecommunications

Backend engineering

Software design, web services, maintenance of the rating engine; web services that hand invoices over to SAP.



05/2009–03/2010

11 months

Master data migration at a major bank

Commerzbank · Frankfurt a. Main — Banking, Finance

Backend engineering

Workflows for persisting master data, a canonical XML model, RDF description for machine processing.



CONTACT & CREDENTIALS

CONTACT & PROFILES

PHONE	+49 15510 249850
BASED IN	Karlstein am Main, Germany
WEBSITE	jenslaufer.com
GITHUB	github.com/jenslaufer
LINKEDIN	linkedin.com/in/jenslaufer
KAGGLE	kaggle.com/jenslaufer
PUBLICATION	Towards Data Science — author

EDUCATION

11/1997
Dipl.-Ing. (Univ.) Electrical Engineering (MSc equivalent)
University of Erlangen-Nuremberg
05/1989
Abitur (university entrance qualification)
Gymnasium am Romäusring, Villingen-Schwenningen

CERTIFICATES

12/2018
Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree
Udacity
Verify →
08/2017
Data Analyst Nanodegree
Udacity
Verify →